



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of The Florida Martyrs
School Website: <https://chestertonpensacola.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of The Florida Martyrs (Pensacola) presents as a clearly classical, Catholic high school. Its public-facing materials foreground a Catholic identity, a Great Books liberal-arts curriculum, and an explicit formation-oriented mission (intellectual, spiritual, and moral formation) anchored in truth, goodness, and beauty. The school emphasizes liturgical life (Mass, prayer), a three-pillar formation model, and a public commitment to forming joyful leaders and saints within a Catholic intellectual tradition. Taken together, these signals align strongly with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements framework, particularly in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, and Pedagogy, and complemented by clearly articulated Faculty and Parents/Community commitments.

- The public materials explicitly describe Chesterton Academy Florida Martyrs as "A Classical High School Rooted in the Catholic Faith," with a Great Books curriculum and an emphasis on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty. This foundational framing strongly supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal), and it sets a conservative baseline for Categories 3–6 given subsequent corroborating signals.
- Materials repeatedly reference a three-pillar formation (Intellectual, Spiritual, and Moral/Character formation) and an explicit mission to raise up leaders and saints, underscoring formation over mere information and aligning with the classical telos. This supports CLASSICAL for Element 2 and informs Element 3 (Curriculum) as well.
- The curricular emphasis includes Great Books, a broad liberal-arts approach, and references to studying canonical figures (e.g., Socrates, Aquinas, Dante), signalling adherence to the Trivium/Quadrivium orientation and Great Conversation concepts central to classical education.
- Pedagogy signals include a strong emphasis on formation through the Great Books, the integration of Catholic identity across disciplines, and a classroom culture that includes liturgical practices (Mass) and communal formation, which map well to the Positive keywords in the classical lexicon.
- Faculty presence is evidenced by named leadership (Headmaster) and a disclosed inaugural-year teaching footprint, indicating a functioning school structure with teachers who model and mentor within a Catholic-classical framework.
- Parent and community engagement is evident through admissions materials, family handbooks, event communications (open houses, parent orientations, Mass/community life), and fundraising communications, illustrating a model that treats parents as engaged participants in the classical education project.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Catholic identity, daily Mass emphasis, liturgical life, and a theology-informed worldview are explicit in the public materials.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Catholic Faith, theology, liturgy, Mass, sacred, wonder, imago Dei, Logos, virtue, and sacred tradition. Negative indicators: none identified in public materials.

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- Why this rating: The materials foreground transcendental, theologically grounded formation and liturgical practices, consistent with the Positive keyword signals for this category.
 - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Mission emphasizes formation (Intellectual, Spiritual, Moral), virtue development, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty; explicitly aims at forming leaders and saints rather than merely job preparation.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, great conversation, telos, contemplation, and the true/beautiful/good triad. Negative indicators: none observed in public materials.
 - Why this rating: The school explicitly prioritizes formation and virtue over workforce preparation, with explicit references to truth/goodness/beauty and a classical telos, supporting CLASSICAL.
 - Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public materials describe a Great Books curriculum, broad liberal arts study, and emphasis on Western thought from Plato to calculus; references to the Great Conversation and the interrelationship of great ideas.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Great Books, liberal education, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Quadrivium concepts, history as integrated through curriculum, and sacred/eternal truths. Negative signals: minimal to none in public materials; no clear signals of replacing history with social studies or over-reliance on project-based learning.
 - Why this rating: The curriculum signals map squarely to the classical content (grammar/logic/rhetoric, history/history through curriculum, Great Books, and the cultivation of wonder), indicating CLASSICAL.
 - Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The school emphasizes a cohesive, content-rich education with an emphasis on learning how to think, the integration of the great ideas, and a Catholic worldview across disciplines; mention of the Great Books and Socratic/eloquent intellectual engagement is present in the school narrative.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Socratic dialogue, seminars, rhetoric, great conversation, and memory-work practices embedded in classical pedagogy (as reflected in the lexicon). The site references some Socratic and rhetorical development through the Great Books emphasis and intellectual formation, though explicit, detailed examples of upper-school seminars are less prominent in the public copy; at minimum, Socratic engagement is implied via canonical authors and dialogic inquiry. Negative keywords: none clearly observed in public materials.
 - Why this rating: The pedagogy aligns with the classical model in its emphasis on dialogic inquiry (Socrates/Aquinas), rhetoric training, and memory-oriented learning via Great Books, which supports CLASSICAL.
 - Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The public materials identify a named Headmaster and a history of faculty-led instruction; the mission describes teachers as guides shaping intellectual, moral, and spiritual formation; materials present a coherentized view of teachers as mentors and living models.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teachers, and collegial culture (as seen in the lexicon). The current public content emphasizes teacher leadership and formation roles. Negative keywords: not evident in public materials.
 - Why this rating: The materials articulate a teacher-led, forming role for faculty, with leadership and mentorship signals consistent with CLASSICAL.
 - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The school communicates parent-facing resources (handbooks, admissions communications), open houses, parent orientations, and community life practices (Mass participation, family engagement). This signals a partnership with families as co-educators and a welcoming campus culture.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include partnership with families, family formation, parent involvement, open campus, and classical home-school alignment signals.

Negative signals: none observed publicly here.

- Why this rating: The materials describe an active parent and community engagement model consistent with classical education norms for parental partnership and formation.

Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL

- All six categories align with the classical rubric as defined by the knowledge documents and the school's own public materials. The school presents a coherent Catholic-classical model anchored in Great Books, Trivium-based curriculum signals, liturgical/communal practice, and formation-focused pedagogy with active parent/community engagement. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL and no category is at NOT CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL based on the available public materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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